

GulfLink Logistics LLC — Freight Billing SOP

Doc GL-FIN-FB-014 | Dubai / Jebel Ali | Systems: CargoWise TMS, SAP, Excel, Outlook

1. Scope

This SOP covers invoice creation for FCL/LCL ocean freight, inland haulage, demurrage, and storage. Billing clerks currently re-key rates from carrier emails into Excel, then post to SAP. The process is time-consuming and creates approval bottlenecks when rates exceed AED 25,000.

2. Systems and data silos

CargoWise holds lane rates; SAP holds GL postings; Excel bridges the gap. Disconnected systems force manual reconciliation every week. Duplicate invoice lines are common when SharePoint folders diverge.

3. Step-by-step workflow

- 1 Receive carrier invoice PDF and POD (scan or WhatsApp photo).
- 2 Open Excel freight billing workbook; manually copy rate, container numbers, and AED amounts.
- 3 Match against CargoWise booking; flag mismatches for finance controller approval.
- 4 If amount $\leq$ AED 5,000: AP clerk posts via email confirmation.
- 5 If amount 5,001–25,000: Finance Controller approves in SAP FB60.
- 6 If amount $>$ 25,000: CFO dual approval required — known bottleneck when CFO travels.
- 7 Archive PDF + Excel row in SharePoint; update month-end close pack by copy-paste.

4. Pain points (for discovery / intelligence)

Manual spreadsheets, repetitive data entry, approval bottlenecks, and coordination via email/WhatsApp handoffs between warehouse and finance. Demurrage spikes after customs delays at Jebel Ali worsen cash timing.

5. Target state

Integrate CargoWise → SAP without Excel bridge; auto-attach POD OCR text; route dual approvals in-system.